

Mid-Semester Examination
HS7.301 Science, Technology and Society

Max Marks: 60

28 February 2026

Instructions:

Answer ALL questions in approximately 350 words each. Each question is worth 20 marks.

- 1) Briefly define Lewis Mumford's concept of technics (6). Use Mumford's framework to describe the many ways in which the design or use of a microwave reflects a broader system of social and cultural values or organizational structures (14 marks). (CO-2)
- 2) Define Jacques Ellul's concept of technique (6 marks). Explain how a biometric id system embodies technique in Ellul's sense (14 marks). (CO-2)
- 3) If you were to use the framework of social construction, how would you go about studying the evolution of smart phones? Describe the basic methodology you would use (8 marks), as well as the broad contours of your analysis (12 marks). (CO-1, CO-3)

Note: Do not focus on details of individual phone models. Focus on the *methodology* of a social constructivist analysis.